

HORIZON TECH

Workplace Ethics & Professional Conduct Policy

Social Media, Asset Use, Confidentiality & Reporting Obligations

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Classification: Confidential — Internal Use Only

Department: Legal, Compliance & HR

1. Ethical Standards & Core Obligations

1.1 The Horizon Tech Code of Ethics

Horizon Tech is committed to conducting business with the highest ethical standards. Every employee, contractor, and consultant acting on behalf of the company must uphold the principles of honesty, fairness, transparency, and respect in all professional interactions — whether internal or with clients, partners, regulators, or the public.

1.2 Obligations Summary

The following obligations apply to all individuals engaged by Horizon Tech regardless of employment type, seniority, or location:

- Act honestly and in good faith in all business dealings.
- Protect confidential information belonging to the company, its clients, and partners.
- Comply with all applicable laws, regulations, and internal policies.
- Report known or suspected ethical violations promptly via approved channels.
- Never offer, accept, or facilitate bribes or improper payments of any kind.
- Avoid actual or perceived conflicts of interest and disclose them proactively.

2. Confidentiality & Information Security Obligations

2.1 Definition of Confidential Information

Confidential information includes, but is not limited to: financial data, business strategies, client lists, employee personal data, source code and proprietary algorithms, pricing information, merger and acquisition plans, regulatory filings not yet public, and any information received from clients or partners under a non-disclosure agreement.

2.2 Obligations During & After Employment

Confidentiality obligations apply for the duration of employment and continue for a period of three (3) years after the termination of employment for most categories. Trade secrets and client data obligations are perpetual. Employees must:

- Not copy, transmit, or store confidential information on personal devices or unapproved cloud services.
- Return or destroy all confidential materials upon termination.
- Obtain written approval from Legal before sharing any proprietary information with a third party.

3. Social Media Policy

3.1 Personal Social Media Use

Employees are free to maintain personal social media accounts and express personal views, subject to the following conditions:

- Personal posts must clearly state they represent the employee's own views, not those of Horizon Tech.

- Employees must not disclose any confidential, commercially sensitive, or client-related information.
- Content that could constitute harassment, discrimination, or defamation of colleagues is prohibited.
- Employees must not make statements that could mislead the public about the company's products or financials.

3.2 Official Company Channels

Only authorised members of the Marketing and Communications team may post on Horizon Tech's official social media accounts. Employees who wish to share or reshare company content are encouraged to do so using the approved asset library on the Horizon Portal. Unauthorised use of the company logo, name, or brand assets for personal purposes is prohibited.

3.3 Media & Press Enquiries

All media enquiries — including requests for interviews, comments, or statements — must be directed to the Communications team. Employees who are contacted directly by journalists or media organisations must not respond and should forward the enquiry to communications@horizontech.com immediately.

4. Use of Company Assets

4.1 Company-Issued Devices

All hardware issued by Horizon Tech — including laptops, mobile phones, tablets, and peripheral equipment — remains the property of the company at all times. Devices must be used primarily for business purposes. Incidental personal use is tolerated but must not interfere with professional responsibilities or consume significant company resources.

Asset Type	Permitted Use	Prohibited Use
Laptop / Desktop	Work tasks, approved software, VPN	Personal gaming, torrenting, unlicensed apps
Mobile Phone	Business calls, email, approved apps	Personal streaming services, rooting/jailbreaking
Company Credit Card	Pre-approved business expenses only	Personal purchases, cash advances
Office Equipment	Print, scan, copy for business use	Excessive personal printing, removing equipment
Software Licences	Licensed tools as assigned by IT	Sharing credentials, installing on personal devices

4.2 End-of-Employment Asset Return

All company assets must be returned in good working condition on or before the employee's last working day. Failure to return assets or returning them in a damaged state may result in financial recovery from the final settlement. IT will perform a device wipe and audit within two business days of the asset being returned.

5. Whistleblowing & Speak-Up Policy

5.1 Protected Disclosures

Horizon Tech encourages employees to report suspected misconduct, fraud, safety violations, or unethical behaviour without fear of retaliation. Reports may be made to the employee's line manager, any HR Business Partner, the Legal & Compliance team, or anonymously via the Horizon Ethics Hotline.

Reporting Channel	Contact / Access	Anonymity
Direct Manager	In person or via email	No
HR Business Partner	hr@horizontech.com	No
Legal & Compliance	compliance@horizontech.com	No
Ethics Hotline	Horizon Portal > 'Speak Up'	Yes — fully anonymous
External Regulator	Relevant regulatory authority	Varies

5.2 Non-Retaliation Commitment

Any form of retaliation against an employee who makes a good-faith report — including demotion, dismissal, ostracism, or any adverse change in working conditions — is itself a serious violation of this policy and will be subject to immediate disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

6. Intellectual Property

6.1 Work-Product Ownership

Any intellectual property (IP) created by an employee in the course of their employment — including software, designs, methodologies, reports, and inventions — is the sole property of Horizon Tech. Employees assign all rights in such work product to the company as a condition of their employment contract.

6.2 Pre-Existing IP & Side Projects

Employees who have pre-existing IP or who wish to engage in personal projects that may overlap with Horizon Tech's business areas must disclose this in writing to Legal & Compliance before commencing or continuing such activities. Approval will be assessed on a case-by-case basis to avoid conflicts of interest.